CARABAO CUP 2026/27 · SECOND ROUND

Chelsea v Luton Town

Stamford Bridge, London · August 27, 2026 (Thursday) · Kickoff 1:30 PM Central / 19:30 UK

PROJECTED XI — NOT CONFIRMED

NO.	PLAYER / POSITION	FROM	AT CHELSEA	PREVIOUSLY	PLAYING STYLE	KEY STATS
– GK	**Mike Penders** GOALKEEPER	Belgium	Signed 2025; first-team squad from 2026 after a…	Genk; Strasbourg (loan)	Tall, quick off his line and comfortable with the ball at his feet.	2025–26, STRASBOURG (LOAN) 33 Ligue 1 apps, 50 apps all comps
27 RB	**Malo Gusto** RIGHT WING-BACK	France	Since Jan 2023 from Lyon	Olympique Lyonnais	Energetic, tenacious right-sided defender who overlaps hard and defends the touchline aggressively.	2025–26, CHELSEA 34 apps, 3 assists
34 CB	**Josh Acheampong** CENTRE-BACK	England	Academy graduate; first-team regular from 2026	Chelsea academy	Composed young centre-back who reads danger early and is comfortable stepping into midfield with the ball.	—
5 CB	**Maxence Lacroix** CENTRE-BACK	France	July 2026, about £52m ($69m) from Crystal Palace	Crystal Palace; Wolfsburg; Sochaux	Reportedly the fastest centre-back in the Premier League by top speed.	2025–26, CRYSTAL PALACE 35 apps (all starts), 11 clean sheets
– LB	**Pep Chavarría** LEFT WING-BACK	Spain	July 2026 from Rayo Vallecano	Rayo Vallecano; Real Zaragoza	Attacking left wing-back with a reliable delivery and real stamina up and down the flank.	2025–26, RAYO VALLECANO 2 assists, 33 apps
45 CM	**Roméo Lavia** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	Belgium	Since Aug 2023 from Southampton	Southampton; Manchester City academy; Anderlecht academy	Press-resistant holding midfielder who turns out of pressure and keeps the ball moving in tight areas.	2025–26, CHELSEA — INJURY-HIT 8 apps
– CM	**Valentín Barco** LEFT WING-BACK	Argentina	2026	Brighton; Sevilla and Strasbourg (loans); Boca Juniors	Left-footed wing-back with a fine delivery and a low centre of gravity.	2025–26, STRASBOURG 3 goals, 43 apps
7 RW	**Pedro Neto** WINGER	Portugal	Since July 2024, about £54m from Wolves	Wolverhampton Wanderers; Lazio; Braga academy	Direct, one-v-one dribbler who attacks the byline and cuts back.	2025–26, CHELSEA 5 goals, 6 assists
– AM	**Geovany Quenda** WINGER	Portugal	July 2026, about £40m from Sporting CP — deal pre-agreed…	Sporting CP	Direct right-sided winger who can also play wing-back, quick in transition and comfortable taking defenders on one-v-one.	2025–26, SPORTING CP 6 goals, 32 apps
41 LW	**Estêvão** WINGER	Brazil	Since July 2025, £29m plus add-ons from Palmeiras	Palmeiras	Explosive right-sided dribbler who shoots early and often from the left channel.	2025–26, CHELSEA 8 goals, 36 apps
– ST	**Danny Welbeck** CENTRE-FORWARD	England	2026	Brighton; Watford; Arsenal; Manchester United	Experienced forward who presses intelligently and holds the ball up.	2025–26, BRIGHTON 14 goals, 40 apps

Projection only — the official XI is published 60–75 minutes before kickoff. Last updated August 26, 2026, 7:20 PM CT. chelsea-fc-2026-27.netlify.app